

Ansible AWX:

The GUI Configuration Management Automation Tool You Will Love to Use

Ansible AWX is an open source community project that provides a web based user interface and API to manage an organisation's Ansible playbooks, inventories, vaults, and credentials. It is an open source version of Ansible Tower. Ansible AWX makes Ansible simpler for IT teams that are not comfortable with command lines by providing a GUI version of Ansible. This article is a tutorial on how to install and configure it.



Ansible AWX services are deployed inside containers; hence Docker and Docker Compose must be installed in order to run multiple container images. Version 18.x onwards AWX is supported by red hat team via awx operator and not using docker-compose. This installation procedure requires a Kubernetes cluster/minikube and the setup is pretty easy, as described below.

- Docker should be installed in the server machine where AWX is installed.
- Python 3 should be installed on the AWX server and all target machines.
- We are using awx-ee:21.11.0 version.
- Our target machines/hosts are localhost and container.

Installing AWX on Ubuntu using Kubernetes/minikube cluster

For installing AWX in minikube, we have followed the procedure given at <https://github.com/ansible/awx-operator> with some additional steps.

1. Update and upgrade your Debian system before you install Ansible AWX using the following command:

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt -y full-upgrade
```

2. To create a minikube cluster, first install the latest minikube stable release on x86-64 Linux using the command given below:

```
curl -LO https://storage.googleapis.com/minikube/releases/latest/minikube-linux-amd64.
```

```
sudo install minikube-linux-amd64 /usr/local/bin/minikube
```

3. From a terminal, run the following command with sudo privilege (but not logged in as root) to start Kubernetes/minikube with the required CPU number and RAM size:

```
minikube start --cpus=4 --memory=6g --addons=ingress
```

4. Once minikube is deployed, we can check if the node(s) and kube-apiserver communication are working as expected or not by executing the command:

```
minikube kubectl -- get nodes
```